Policy: 3122
Section: 3000 – Students

(DRAFT 10-13-20)

PROPOSED POLICY REVISIONS

Information Item

Rationale: OSPI adopted emergency rules that redefine school "absence" in the context of remote instruction and the recording of daily attendance. The emergency rules also expand the definition of "excused absences" for a pandemic and provide tiered supports for students accruing absences. The policy is updated to include the provision of the emergency rules which are in effect for the 2020-2021 school year.

Excused and Unexcused Absences

Students are expected to attend all assigned classes each day. Upon enrollment and at the beginning of each school year, the district shall inform students and their parents/guardians of this expectation, the benefits of regular school attendance, the consequences of truancy, the role and responsibility of the district in regard to truancy, and resources available to assist the student and their parents and guardians in correcting truancy. The district will also make this information available online and will take reasonable steps to ensure parents can request and be provided such information in languages in which they are fluent. Parents will be required to date and acknowledge review of this information online or in writing.

A. A student is absent when they are:

A. Not physically present on school grounds; and

B. Not participating in the following activities at an approved location:

1. Instruction;

2. Any instruction-related activity; or

3. Any other district or school approved activity that is regulated by an Instructional/academic/athletic accountability system, such as participation in district-sponsored sports.

~~C.~~ 4. On school grounds but not in their assigned setting.

B. Definition of absence from remote learning

1. A student is absent from remote learning when the student is not participating in planned instructional activities on a scheduled remote learning day.

2. Evidence of student participation in remote learning may include, but is not limited to:

a) Daily logins to learning management systems;

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b) Daily interactions with the teacher to acknowledge attendance (including messages, emails, phone calls or video chats); or

c) Evidence of participation in a task or assignment. ~~Students are not absent if:~~

~~1. They have been suspended, expelled or emergency expelled pursuant to WAC 392-400;~~

~~2. Are receiving educational services as required by RCW 28A.600.015 and WAC 392-400; and~~

~~3. The student is enrolled in qualifying "course of study" activities as defined in WAC 392-121-107.~~

~~C. A full day absence is when a student is absent for fifty percent or more of their scheduled day.~~

~~D. Schools will not convert or combine tardies into absences that contribute to a truancy petition.~~

The superintendent or designee shall develop a procedure defining excused and unexcused absences.

Legal References:	Chapter 28A.225 RCW 13.34.300 WAC 392-400-325 WAC 392-401-015

Adopted: May 8, 2018

Revised: January 22, 2019

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